in the same breath and their differences made to look like a natural agenda left over from Partition. There were even periods when a military regime in our neighbouring country was held out as an example of development! The 1971 outcome obviously changed much of this, but not as decisively as India would have hoped. Pakistan kept trying to create an artificial balance and was actively supported in that endeavour by both China and Western nations. This even went to the extent of assisting and facilitating its nuclear and missile programmes. And worse still, Pakistan increasingly resorted to cross-border terrorism to bring India to the table.

If truth be told, our own policies were not sufficiently robust to firmly discourage this approach either. Instead of confronting the cross-border nature of terrorism emanating from Pakistan, we even appeared to be open at Havana and Sharm El-Sheikh to a narrative that suggested that both India and Pakistan were victims of terrorism. This was exactly the false equivalence that Mookerjee cautioned us about in his time.

So, what is the answer? We have seen that unfold over the last decade in a variety of ways. To begin with, this means a clear position on the unacceptability of cross-border terrorism. It is obviously not in our national interest that we normalize terrorism by carrying on with the rest of the relationship as usual. That message has been sent loud and clear. Where egregious actions of cross-border terrorism are concerned, the operations at Uri and Balakot are as much a shift in our thinking as in our action.

It is also important to mobilize the international community through advocacy and awareness creation. Only then can we be successful in delegitimizing terrorism. As a result of our diligent efforts, there is widespread understanding today that this is not a threat to India alone. That the UNSC’s Counter-Terrorism Committee (CTC) held a meeting at a 26/11 site in Mumbai was a statement of no small significance. It is also our endeavour to get global platforms and conferences, whether we speak of the G20, meetings like ‘No Money for Terror’ or bilateral and plurilateral mechanisms, to keep the spotlight strongly on such threats. The listing process created by the UNSC 1267 Sanctions Committee has its own importance. And there are no prizes for guessing which country features prominently in it!